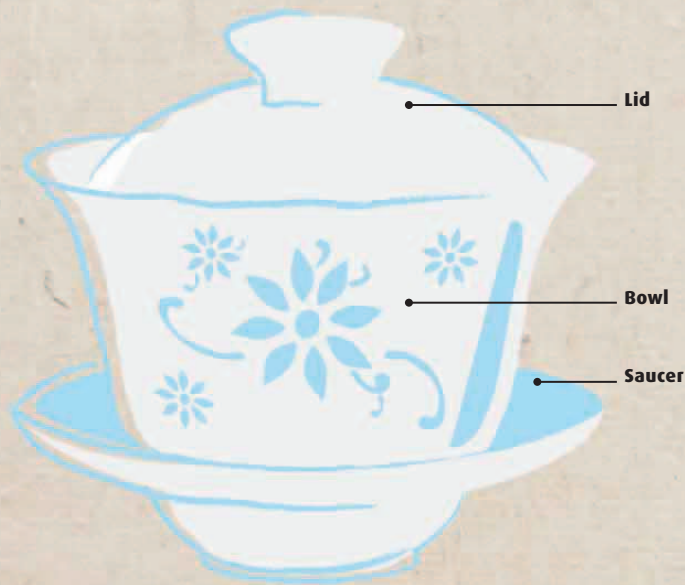


GAIWAN

Used in China to prepare tea, the “gaiwan,” or “lidded bowl,” comes with a saucer and holds about $\frac{3}{4}$ cup of liquid, the same size as a classic china teacup. To make tea, place the tea leaves in the gaiwan, add water, and leave to steep. The standard steeping times can be reduced because of the shape and size of the vessel—the domed lid allows good air flow and condensation, while the vessel, widening toward the top, allows the leaves plenty of room to release their flavors. Pour into a cup to serve, slightly tipping the lid so that the leaves remain inside, ready to be used for the next infusion. In China, some people drink directly from the gaiwan, leaves and all.

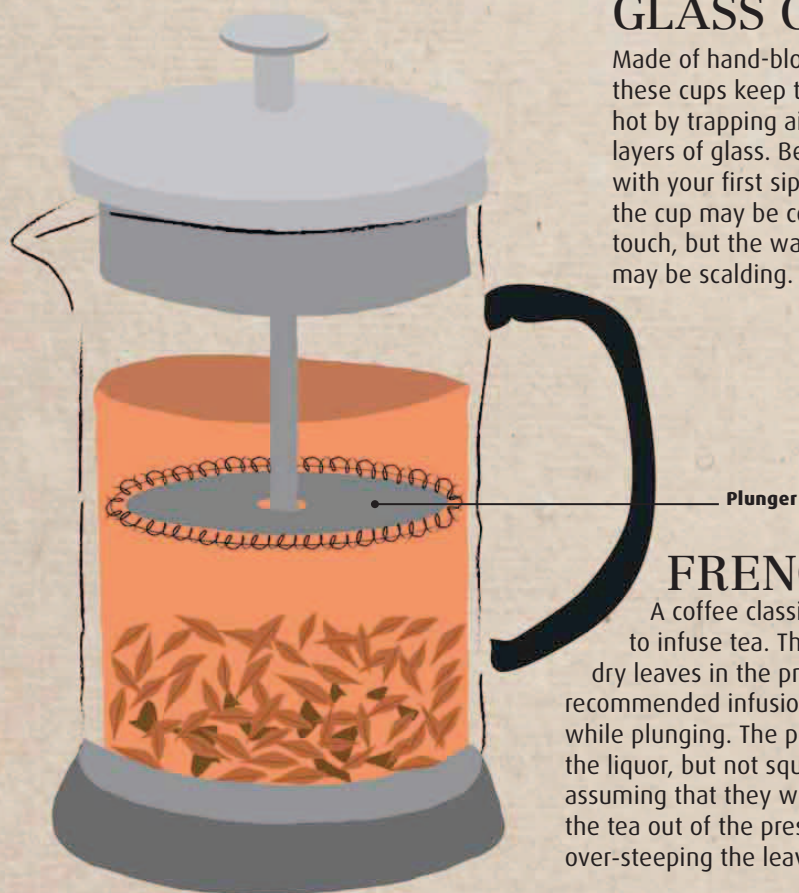


DOUBLE-WALLED GLASS CUP

Made of hand-blown glass, these cups keep the liquid hot by trapping air between layers of glass. Be careful with your first sip, though; the cup may be cool to the touch, but the water inside may be scalding.



Inner glass layer



FRENCH PRESS

A coffee classic, the French press is also commonly used to infuse tea. The method of use is the same. Place the dry leaves in the press, pour the water over, leave for the recommended infusion time, and plunge. Use a light touch while plunging. The plunger should separate the leaves from the liquor, but not squeeze them enough to damage them, assuming that they will be used for another infusion. Pour all the tea out of the press when the infusion is ready to avoid over-steeping the leaves.